



▲ **BIRD'S EYE VIEW** The mountainous terrain of Badrinath has been made more accessible through heli tourism

brehtaking views of Adi Kailash and Om Parvat without having to scale the peaks? The Uttarakhand government has got you covered. As recently as April this year, the state's tourism development board launched India's first helicopter service for these elusive terrains.

And in the southern part of India, enjoy the landscapes of 'God's Own Country' from a new, aerial perspective before dipping

your toes in the water. The Kerala government's 'Sky Escapes' project will help you do just that. A seven-minute helicopter ride over the Chalakkudy River is priced at ₹4,000 per person. Similarly, the pristine beaches of Goa can also be viewed from the skies.

Heli tourism is also connecting the farthest corners in the eastern side of the country. A ride from Guwahati to Shillong costs

₹1,500 per person, whereas from Guwahati to Tura, it is priced at ₹1,700. Similarly, in scenic Sikkim, a helicopter tour will take you to one of the highest motorable roads in the world—Nathu La. The cost of a trip from Gangtok to Nathu La starts from ₹13,000 per head. A ride over the picturesque North Sikkim—to Lachung, Yumthang Valley, and Zero Point—costs ₹20,000 per head.

One thing is certain: Heli tourism is poised to redefine how we explore and experience the most remote and beautiful landscapes in India. So for your next vacation, choose a destination that offers helicopter rides and prepare yourself for a whole new experience. **BT**

NOW, ONE CAN TAKE A CHOPPER ON THE FAMOUS CHAR DHAM YATRA IN THE MOUNTAINS OF UTTARAKHAND

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